GOFILEROOM

Implementation Best Practices Guide

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* Any heading with an asterisk indicates there is more information on the subject in their respective best practice guide that will be provided based on your specific contract.

Introduction

The GoFileRoom Implementation Best Practices Guide outlines an approach for implementing GoFileRoom and will help you prepare for the decisions your firm will need to make during implementation to ensure a smooth rollout. This guide leverages the knowledge gained by other firms, so you won't need to reinvent the wheel.

This guide is designed specifically for accounting firms. Whether your firm has one GoFileRoom user or thousands of users, one location, or multiple locations, you can use this guide to improve your firm's efficiency and increase productivity. This guide can help your firm reduce initial costs by answering common questions that come up during process decisions and setup. It also provides strategies that are used by some of the country's most successful accounting firms.

This guide includes the following:

- High level overview of additional modules
- Key terms defined and examples of common practice areas.
- A consultative approach for transforming every area of your firm into a paperless environment
- Document organization for indexing (including file sections and document types)
- Answers to common questions (FAQs)

GoFileRoom Users

Your firm should identify Champion Users who will take on the responsibility of mastering GoFileRoom skills and applying them to firm procedures. The following list outlines the qualities your Champion Users should possess:

- Show initiative, patience, commitment, and leadership
- Are experts in their functional areas (audit, tax, and so on)
- Are well versed in firm processes and procedures
- Can answer questions about processes and procedures
- Can be available as the go-to people throughout the process
- Are well respected by their peers, work well with people, and are team players
- Are willing to train and serve as GoFileRoom advisors for their peers / offices
- Serve as the primary liaisons for the staff and partners
- Are integral parts of the communication channel

Technical Services

The Technical Services team can provide customized solutions that will simplify and speed up complex, time-consuming tasks during the GoFileRoom implementation process as follows:

- Custom document migrations into GoFileRoom
- Custom back-end updates of data into GoFileRoom document management

Migration Services

Migration services will help you get documents from your legacy document management system to GoFileRoom and requires a separate technical services contract. The document migration process is customized based on where your firm are stored documents and how your firm has set up GoFileRoom. Your firm should expect to commit some time to the migration process. The amount of time needed typically depends on the number of documents being migrated and on the consistency in naming conventions used to store documents along with the indexes in GoFileRoom. A consultant will be assigned to get you started and will provide the best practice guide for migration services during your call.

Contact your GoFileRoom sales representative for more information about technical services.

GoFileRoom and Modules

This chapter provides information about the various modules that comprise GoFileRoom.
The modules will have their own best practice guides available, for implementation purposes.

GoFileRoom

GoFileRoom is the firm's centralized online file room. With instant access to all documents, your firm will increase productivity and improve client services. GoFileRoom organizes electronic documents into virtual online file cabinets from which you can instantly retrieve your documents — anytime, anywhere. GoFileRoom integrates with Microsoft Word, Excel, and Outlook, Adobe Acrobat, and most leading tax and accounting software applications.

- Document Management: Easy to implement, easy to learn, and easy to manage. Your staff will gain efficiency through:
    - Powerful search optimization methods using indexes
    - Capability in live documents
    - Ability to quickly recall recently viewed documents
- Cloud-Based: Documents are accessed from anywhere via the Internet (from the office, your home or client sites).
- Rapidly Deployed: By leveraging our best practices for implementation and outsourcing the technical infrastructure, GoFileRoom can be rolled out to your firm quickly.
- Includes enterprise-level security: Maintain full control of your documents while ensuring their integrity using our advanced security features.

FirmFlow*

FirmFlow streamlines and standardizes your firm's client-related processes by automating your workflows. You can also enable FirmFlow for your non-client drawers to help manage internal processes like human resources or recruiting. FirmFlow helps you capture documents; track tax, audit, or any other project engagements; and automate the routing of folders. FirmFlow also provides a complete due-date monitoring system.

- **FirmFlow folders:** Engagement folders contain all your engagement-specific documents in a single, organized electronic folder. Engagement folders also contain workflows, deliverables, checklists, delivery instructions, notes, routing information, and much more.
- **Workflow routing:** An electronic FirmFlow folder is created for each engagement. This folder is assigned to individuals or groups, and they are notified in the FirmFlow My Work page that work needs to be done in the folder (for example, a folder is routed to the preparation step and assigned to a preparer or the Tax Prep pool group). When the work is completed, the folder is routed to other individuals or groups, and it is moved along to the next step (for example, Review) until the workflow is completed.
- **Reporting tools:** Due Date Tracking reports allow you to monitor submission deadlines and extensions, including multiple due dates for the same client. WIP reports enable management to analyze and adjust current workload by employee or office location. Users can see the status and location of any engagement in real time.

** Denotes a module that requires a separate license from GoFileRoom.*

- If FirmFlow is not included with your current GoFileRoom implementation, please contact your sales representative or consultant for more information.
- You can use FirmFlow as an add-on component of the GoFileRoom document management system.

AdvanceFlow*

AdvanceFlow is a secure, web-based, cost-effective, paperless solution that can help your firm process workpapers, trial balances, journal entries, financial statements, and tax returns for your clients. AdvanceFlow is typically used for firms completing audit, review, compilation, preparation, and tax engagements.

AdvanceFlow provides the following capabilities:

- **Standardized Templates:** Enables the use of standardized folder and document templates to ease the creation of engagements.
- **Standardized Account Groupings and Tax Subcodes:** Allows for the use of standardized account groupings and tax subcodes to efficiently set up financial statements and export trial balance information to tax software.
- **Trial Balance Structures:** Provides powerful account structure possibilities for divisional, fund, and consolidated trial balances.
- **Integration:** Integrates with Checkpoint Engage for state-of-the-art audit, review, compilation, and preparation methodology; integrates with SMART Practice Aids, and integrates with most widely used tax software programs.

ClientFlow for NetClient CS*

The GoFileRoom ClientFlow module is an online portal system that enables firms to securely share documents such as tax returns and financial statements with their clients. Clients can also upload documents to the portal for the firm to view, such as tax source documents and bank statements. The firm's clients can access documents by logging in to ClientFlow through a link on the firm's website. The client can view only those documents that the firm has published to the client (such as tax returns and financial statements). For added security, all ClientFlow activities, including document publishing and client viewing, are logged in the GoFileRoom audit logs.

- **Improved client service:** Allows you and your clients to share and instantly access critical documents.
- **Improved image for your firm:** Demonstrates to your clients that the firm is investing in the latest web-based technologies.
- **Enhanced security:** Data is transmitted over a secure, encrypted channel which provides greater security and confidentiality over unencrypted email and supports compliance with HIPAA requirements.

ScanFlow*

ScanFlow is a plug-in for Adobe Acrobat (Standard or Professional) that enables batch scanning of documents into GoFileRoom. The barcode function facilitates a centralized scanning process and provides a quality control review of all scanned images.

ScanFlow provides the following capabilities:

- **Accuracy:** Document barcoding for high-volume scanning improves the efficiency of your scanning operation, reduces the possibility of errors, and enables tracking to ensure that no documents are lost.
- **Flexibility:** Supports most standalone production scanners.
- **Quality:** Takes advantage of image enhancement technology that dramatically improves the quality of scanned images.

Using GoFileRoom

You have several options to consider when setting up GoFileRoom for managing your firm's documents. Among those are deciding which drawers and indexes your firm needs as well as providing the proper access to the documents. You will receive the technical information on each of those areas by attending the appropriate classes, or by referencing the appropriate Help and Support article. This document is meant to give you guidance on the "why" for each subsection.

Setting up and getting to know your environment

First and foremost, you should have been scheduled for, or may have completed, the Workstation & Utilities Setup call. If you have not, please contact support by following this link Chat & E-mail Support or by calling 800.968.0600. If you prefer the GoFileRoom setup Help and Support article it can be found here.

The technical steps for this area are covered in the GoFileRoom Technical Administration Class. You may also choose to reference this Help and Support article that covers the administration features for the security levels: Administrator, User Administrator, FirmFlow Administrator, Restricted Drawer Owner and Records Manager. In addition, you may choose to refer topics in the Administration group of articles for topics related to user and group management, drawer properties, and configuration.

To access the program, you should have received a username and password from Thomson Reuters or your Administrator. To log in, open a Chrome browser and type in www.gofileroom.com.

What is the difference between a document management system and a document storage system?

A document storage system is similar to a windows explorer filing system. It is usually driven by dates or folder structures, but the data is locked from making changes. A document storage system works the same for documents, however, most do not have the ability to launch another application for editing. The data is static and must be replaced when it needs edited.

A document management system has all the functionality of a storage system but adds the ability to edit the "live" document by launching the necessary application. GoFileRoom not only boosts the basic storage concept, but it also has powerful searching capabilities that can read any document that has been processed with optical character recognition (OCR) and allows you to edit those documents in Word, Excel and Adobe. So, if you store a Word document you can open it from GoFileRoom, the document will load in Word and you can save any changes bidirectionally on that document.

What is an index?

Your database came with many items pre-configured so that you do not have to start from scratch. The items in the database are what Thomson Reuters has gathered as the most common for each area and consider them to be best practices. You can make changes to the drawers that are offered within your firm as well as the indexes and document types. By the end of this section, you should be able to explain what an index and document type are, why you should be careful before you add or remove one, and what defines a good use case.

Everything that lives in GoFileRoom requires some basic information so that it is easy to search and find what you are looking for. When adding a document to the Client Drawer, the document must be associated with a client name, client number, file section and document type. These descriptions are called indexes in the GoFileRoom software. Indexes allow you to think in general top-level filing sections and document types so that there is standardization and consistency in filing and finding documents.

Index values allow you to search for documents based on *what* they are rather than *where* they are.

The 8 Index Values on a typical Clients Drawer in GoFileRoom are:

- Client Name & Number – these allow you to search for the WHO to which the documents belong.
- File Section & Document Type – the values are decided by the firm and should indicate what you do as a firm. Both indexes stand for "WHAT" the document is used for and represents both internal and external services.
    - For these Indexes, the File Section is the parent index, and the Document Type is the child index. This means the Document Type options will change based on what File Section is selected.
- Description - a text-based field. You can enter a description to the document that allows for the unique information beyond the set indexes that the implementation team has set up. This is how you indicate what this particular "1040 Individual tax /workpaper" truly is.
    - It is often recommended to offer firmwide acronyms for common items, like, PBC to identify that the workpaper was provided by client rather than repeatedly entering the full string of text.
- Year, Period End Date, and Document Date – this is the WHEN. These index values allow you to find a document based on what year, a specific timeline the document was used for, or what date the document was created on.

File Section Index:

If you associate an Index with a filter or a tag you are close to right! Each document is marked with an index within the drawer so that they stay grouped correctly. One of the required indexes is File Section.

To help clarify what a file section would look like, let's take the client drawer as an example. There are four "areas" in the client file section that depict a department. Tax, Assurance, Accounting and Other (typically covering things like Litigation, Business Valuations, or Consulting). There is also a General file area with a file section called Permanent. For your firm, consider what top level departments work with client documents. Do they fit into these predefined file areas? Under each heading there are file section indexes that are available to choose when adding or searching for a document. In Tax, we call out the areas of service for tax like 1040, 1065, or 706. What services in tax does your firm offer?

You can adjust the file areas (Tax, Assurance, Accounting, etc.) by removing ones that don't apply – or adding ones that are not listed – and you can edit the file sections within the area. For example, maybe your firm does Tax, but does not do anything related to gift tax. In this case you could remove the gift tax file section. This is where your questions should start for File Sections!

When should I add a new File Section?

Before you add a new file section, think about the majority rule. Does this file section have a lot of documentation that doesn't fall into one of the predefined areas and could it? Maybe you don't need an entirely new file section, you just need to add a document type to a specific file section. One common example is in the Accounting Services Area. Many firms add a W2 file section because they have yearend only clients that just have W2's processed.

Some items may not need a full file section but does need a little more information to find it. Another Payroll example would be the quarterly filing. Instead of adding new document types for each quarter, you can use the company defined naming scheme for description. Each quarterly document that is files should have QTR #: before each description. For example, QTR 3: BWC would be a good standard to find a quarterly report for the Bureau of Workers Comp report. You will then be able to use a search by description to easily find it.

Whichever way makes the most sense for your firm, with GoFileRoom, you never have to wade through tons of folders or know where documents are, they can easily be located through the powerful search!

When should I remove a File Section?

After a lot of consideration!! If possible, it is best practice to remove BEFORE going live. Trying to remove a file section after users have added documents to the database requires more vigilant steps.

During the design phase, before the database is live, you can delete a file section if it is not going to be used by your firm. Note in any case, if you delete at the file section level, all document types will also be deleted. You can add them back if you change your mind but that is more involved than just clicking a restore button. Remember the File Section is the parent, and the Document Type is the child. No parent equals no children.

If you do find that a file section needs to be removed after your firm is actively using the database, first ask, has this file section been in use (even for a day)? To find out, you need to search for all documents in that file section before you delete! If you find any documents in the search you should reindex them, before you hit the button! If you make a mistake and delete first, all is not lost as you can choose to cancel but finding the "orphan" documents can be a lot more tedious than being thoughtful and searching beforehand!

What is Permanent File Section, it doesn't look like my permanent file?

Remember the file areas apply to everything client related, not just tax. Think of permanent more as the word is defined rather than in the vein of a "tax perm file". That means you may need a business and industry document type for your bookkeeping staff to store specific changes to reports for a construction client, or the litigation document type for clients that have been ordered an e-discovery for which you are now liable to provide documentation. Another common example are documents that span cross multiple years and areas, like a divorce decree or a POA.

Permanent files should never be deleted so creating a "keep" retention policy in the RecordsFlow management area will ensure this. For a full overview of policies, as well as links with instructions on creating them, please review the Help and Support article.

Document Types Index:

Now that we know about File Sections, what about document type? Document type is another required index in all drawers, and it is fully dependent on the File Section. In geek language, the File Section is the parent, and the Document Type is the child. Document types will often be repeated in a file section series. To continue our example on Tax: 1040, 1065, 1120, and so on all have the same list for document types because they are similar! For example, all tax areas have a tax return, correspondence, engagement letter, and workpapers. As with the File Section, you can add or remove items from the list. Perhaps you don't do an engagement letter, so you don't need an engagement letter document type. You can remove it from the list in any area that doesn't apply.

Do all my tax items have to have the same document list?

No! Just like the example of removing the gift tax returns from the tax file section you can remove or add document types. The same thoughts should apply before you add or remove, of course, like how useful is it to add a document type or has anyone filed documents in an existing document type, however sometimes you need an extra item in 1040 that you would not see in a business return. Some companies like to have a document type for 8879 because they reference them frequently. To answer your follow up question, others put the 8879 in the workpapers document type and add a description.

There are a lot of document types, especially in the Permanent file sections we will never use, should I keep them?

No. Making all the lists as concise as possible is your best method, always, regardless of which list we are talking about. The thought process is twofold: First, if there are too many items in a list, people will feel overwhelmed and just start defaulting to whatever is at the top; Second, if the item is there *someone* **will** use it which makes for a poor filing system.

Rule of thumb, if it isn't relevant to your business or if your staff will not know what it is at first glance, get rid of it or rename it to your firms' appropriate language! Also, if you choose to keep "other" as a document type, ensure that it is used sparingly. Review what is placed in "other", periodically, to ensure the documents should not be elsewhere, or to determine if a new document type is needed.

Why do all file sections have "workpapers" document type?

Workpapers represents all supporting documents to complete the task in each area. If you have a client that you offer full service to, Tax, Accounting, Audit and Consulting there should be a workpapers document type in each one to support that area of focus. This is also imperative to keep if you have purchased, or ever plan to purchase, AdvanceFlow. All documents in AdvanceFlow can be edited, tagged, referenced from the AdvanceFlow interface but they physically reside in GoFileRoom Workpapers. Please **do not remove** workpapers from any of the document types.

Manage Users and Groups

You must have administrative privileges to access this part of the database.

The first item to consider is who needs access to the program and what access should they have. This should be a resounding "everyone" can access, at a minimum, the client drawer. Verify that you have enough licenses for all users to access GoFileRoom. It will be covered shortly that all firm documents can live in GoFileRoom so remember to include your administrators, support staff, and general staff.

The technical class or document referenced above will go into detail on how to set up a user so let's discuss some of the items that you should consider before you start.

Are you adding full time permanent staff or part-time seasonal?

- Every user that accesses the system must have a license. GoFileRoom requires a unique username (usually the company e-mail address) for each license that is assigned.
    - The users can only log in one time from one location. If they are logged in on computer A then try to log in on computer B, they will be given a warning that the user is already logged in and will disconnect the original connection.
    - As you disable users, the license will be freed up, and you can reuse it.
- To verify your license count, open Administration > Manage Users & Groups.
    - ✓ Look towards the center of the list for "License Type".
    - ✓ To the right you will see that "dedicated" is selected and next to it will be the number of licenses you have.
    - ✓ If this number is incorrect you need to contact your salesperson or consultant to get it corrected.
- If you have added a user and you click save, wait a few seconds for the "user setup successfully" box appears.
    - ✓ Clicking save multiple times can cause errors.
    - ✓ If the popup states that the user already exists check to see if they are in the disabled user list.
    - ✓ To do this go to the top of the user's screen.
        - Next to the white "new user" drop down box uncheck the "active" checkbox.
        - If the drop down turns white, the user you are creating may not exist in your database but does exist somewhere in the GoFileRoom databases with that username.
        - You will need to either change their username to make it unique or ask the user if they have ever used that e-mail address with a portal that they access with another accounting firm. If so, you will need to contact that company and have them delete the user. They must delete or change the login, disable will not free the use of the name.

Did you purchase FirmFlow or AdvanceFlow?

- If yes, you should be able to verify the number of licenses from the user setup screen.
- Each user that needs to see or use the module will need a license.
- To apply the module, just check the box.
- If you disable a user in GoFileRoom, it will disable the user from all aspects and free up the license for every module as well.

What groups do you need?

Your database has some predefined groups that we will discuss here as well as managing your users via the groups. This will also be covered in the HHTC articles, classes, and other best practice guides. The focus of this guide is to give you the best approach to keep the groups clean and the users straight.

All access to drawers and areas within GoFileRoom are managed by groups. You can manage some overriding permissions for individuals but that should be the exception not the rule. An important item to remember is that individual permission ***overrides*** group permissions!

While you are in the administration, manage user's area, click on the groups tab. You will see many groups already listed. Usually the first is D-Clients-[RAED] followed by D-Clients-[RAE]. This repeats for each drawer, in most cases.

To break this down:

- D – means drawer. All drawer related permission starts with D dash.
    - If you have purchased FirmFlow you will also see permissions lower in the list that start with F (indicating a FirmFlow permission) or a P (indicating a Pool permission)
- Clients – in this case means the Clients drawer. So, it is given that whatever drawer names follows the D is the drawer that is being accessed.
- [RAED] is for Read, Add, Edit, Delete. Some groups have an extra permission of L. Please see the chart below for a further explanation.

Group	Permissions
Read	User can view and print all documents in the drawer
Add	User can add new documents to the drawer
Edit	User can open, modify, or re-index any document in the drawer
Delete	User can delete any document in the drawer
Lookup Management	User can add, modify, delete any items in the Lookup List which includes client names and numbers

Why do some groups not have a letter in front?

These groups are system groups and should NOT be altered or deleted. An example is the Administrator group. This group gives administrative rights to the entire system. If you change or remove the name of this group, it cannot be repaired. It will break access to some areas and will break some reports.

Can I add or delete groups?

Be careful! You can add groups, but you can ***never*** (ever) delete them! If there are groups in your system, you can rename them, and use them again later. For example, if you want to remove the D-AP [RAEDL] group because you will not be using the drawer, you will want to "zombie" the group by renaming it to Z – use later. To rename a group, or to make it inactive, do the following:

- In GoFileRoom, go to Administration | Manage Users and Groups | Groups Permissions tab
  - ✓ Locate the group you wish to set to use later from the group drop down list, in our example choose D-AP [RAEDL]
  - ✓ Remove all the checkmarks from the boxes (don't forget the one that is next to your firm name under Read)
  - ✓ Click Save
- Now click the Groups tab
  - ✓ Choose the same group in the drop-down box next to select group (if it isn't already shown)
  - ✓ In the group name box enter Z-use later
  - ✓ Remove any group members that are in the lower boxes by highlighting anyone on the left and using the arrow to move them back to the right
  - ✓ Click Save

This permission group can now be renamed and reused in the same fashion later. In your group list you will see that the D-AP group is gone but you have a new group name at the bottom of your list called Z – use later. **NOTE – you can name multiple groups the ***same*** name, so, if you decide you don't want 3 drawers you can rename the permissions for all 3 drawers to the same Z – use later, following this procedure.

You are probably wondering why you would add a group. Again, caution here is key and is usually wise to wait a bit, using the system, before you dive into making large permission changes from the default. There are situations that warrant it for some firms. Perhaps you have a high-profile client, like a professional sports team, and only specific people at the firm can work on it. You could set up a security group that allows only the designated staff to see the documents for that restricted client, or group of clients. In this case we suggest renaming one of the Z groups, or creating a new one, if necessary, that starts with an S so that you know immediately it is a security group. The details on how to set up security groups is covered in this Help and Support article and is taught in the GoFileRoom Beyond the Basics class.

What can the Administrators group do?

Choose the person in your firm that you trust with the heavy lifting of Administrator. This should be a finite group of individuals, typically restricted to two people with one of them being a backup Partner or someone that is tech savvy in case the administrator is out or there are issues that need authority to resolve. You can also have a person that is a "user administrator" to deal with lockouts or missing permissions and a "portal administrator" to help manage portals, if the full Administrator is out. These user and portal administrators are restricted to their restricted screens.

Administrator group goes beyond drawer permission. It is the full administrator to the database and means that they have full rights to go into any area they want. Administrators can access any drawer that isn't *restricted;* however, if they don't have permission to a drawer, they will not be able to work in them.

To flush that out, if Robert is your system and administrator, a tax preparer, and a member of the HR team he would need the following permissions:

- Administrator, D-Clients [RAED], D-Library [RAED], D-HR [RAED], [Homepage Users], and [RecordsFlow Users].

If he only had Administrator, he would be able to log into the system and get the Administration tab, but he would not have access to the Homepage dashboard, Clients, Library, HR drawers or be able to manage the document retention policies in the RecordsFlow area. This tends to trip people up so remember if your administrator (or any user) can't reach a drawer, they likely do not have the proper permission group.

What permissions do the staff need?

For general staff they should have, at a minimum, the Clients [RAED], Library [R], and [Homepage Users] groups. Staff should then be added to the drawers that they need access to defined by the job function or role that they have at the firm. This will be covered in your GoFileRoom Technical Admin class; however there a few key points that need further explanation listed below.

Client drawer: For each drawer there is a group for [RAED] and [RAE]. It is strongly recommended that for the Client drawer all users can have the delete right [RAED]. There is a recycle bin in GoFileRoom that is easy to restore from and is managed by the firm's system administrator and record managers. There are many instances in a month that employees need to remove something from the database that is outdated or no longer relevant. If you restrict who has delete rights, it can cause employees to be less productive for both the person that needs the document deleted and the person the employee must interrupt to get it deleted. It has been proven, over time, that those that do not allow the delete permission on the Clients drawer end up with bad data in their database. Remember, a database is only as good as the data that is in it!

RecordsFlow: This is permission to manage the recycle bin and retention policies. This area requires two users to create, execute, or edit any retention policy, including setting up an auto purge on the recycle bin. It is recommended that this remains a small number of people as this is the master key to what is ultimately deleted in the system and is not recoverable once shed.

It's all about the drawers!

Your database came with many items pre-configured so that you do not have to start from scratch. The items in the database are what Thomson Reuters has gathered as the most common for each area and consider them to be best practice. You can make changes to the drawers that are offered within your firm as well as the indexes and document types.

As you may know, GoFileRoom is meant to be an 'all in one place' to store all firm and client related documents! The first thing you should consider is what types of documents live in your environment. Most people can make this list in a hurry! The good news is if you have a document, GoFileRoom has a place to put it! That includes items that are general firm knowledge (Library), private employee files (HR), private firm related items like financials (Partner), and even items relating to your infrastructure or employee equipment (Firm Admin). Each drawer has its own set of permissions and cannot be searched or "accidently" found by a wondering employee. In fact, if the employee does not have access to a drawer, they will not even see it in their drop-down lists!

The GoFileRoom Technical Administration Class will detail how to turn a drawer on or off, add or remove features, set security, and manage the file room. This section will give you best practice items to think about before you start the journey to customize!

The drawers included with your purchase include: Client, Library, MyFiles, Firm Admin, Partner, HR, AP Recruiting, & CPE. Below, each drawer title there is a short outline of what might be housed there and specific topics to consider in the design. By the end of this section, you should be able to define what each drawer is used for and have a good list of questions to consider before changing or adding an area.

By way of best practice, typically the Client Drawer and the Library Drawer are meant to be an "open" filing system with little to no restrictions for the entire staff. These two drawers should also be considered your focus for the first year. After your firm becomes familiar with using GoFileRoom you can use the additional drawer structure to house all the documents in your firm.

The other drawers listed have varied types of security that should be applied including limited or no permissions based on the role the staff has in the firm as described earlier in this guide.

Client Drawer

Client List

The client list can be maintained 2 ways. *In either case, it is important to remember client numbers can only be alpha numeric, no special characters. Also, if you are using Practice CS they cannot be more than 11 total characters.*

First, you can initially import a list from Excel then manually update the clients in GoFileRoom or link to that Excel file, that will be put in a specific location on your network and maintain the client list there. If you put the file on your network, you can apply the logic of the second method below and not have to manually import the list after each change.

If you completed the workstation setup call and have a time and billing system that uses SQL, you can connect using a script to auto-update your client list in GoFileRoom (there may be an additional cost for Foundational implementations). The script will read the time and billing software (or the Excel file) every 4 hours and update any changes, adds, or inactivated clients back to GoFileRoom.

File Sections and Document Types

You guessed it! All client related items live here. Each document will be filed by the client's name and ID so any search you perform, by client, will return documents related to them! The nice change from using a folder structure means that you don't have to remember where you put a document. On a server you may have had client subfolders in any set of administrative, financial, or years that you had to wade through to get what you needed. You had to remember the "where" before you cared about the "who" or the "what"! Now, you can search the entire database in a few clicks!

We have covered that each drawer has File Sections and Document types. The file section list for Client, and each subsequent drawer, can be printed directly from the database by a firm administrator. Log in as an administrator, go to Administration | Manage Fileroom. Choose the second tab called "lists". In the drop down chose the drawer you want to print. In the lower right choose Export. This will send the list of file section and document types to Excel.

You have the option to edit every File Section and Document type in the database but remember the outline of some do's and don'ts previously discussed. Some find it easiest to use the exported list, sharing with the implementation team, to mark up what you would like to add or remove before you do it live in the database. There isn't an "undo" in GoFileRoom so make sure you really want to delete before you hit the button! You can always add back but it does cause some administrative overhead. Once you have edited the database, it is a good idea to export a new list and add a column that shows examples to your staff of what should be filed in that File Section/Document Type.

File Section	Document Type	Sample Document
- - - - - - - - GENERAL - - - - - - - - -		
PERMANENT	BUSINESS & INDUSTRY INFORMATION	
	CONSENT TO DISCLOSE/USE	
	CONTRACTS, AGREEMENTS, & LEASES	truck fleet lease, new construction contract, partner agreement
BOOKKEEPING	REPORT	cash flow report, monthly P&L

Description

Description will be the areas that have not been covered by the indexes within your current naming conventions. If you do not have current document naming conventions, we recommended keeping it short. Also, anyone in your firm reading it should quickly be able to understand what the document is without having to open in. For example, PBC: Bank Rec indicates it is the bank reconciliation provided by the client.

Every department has client documents!

An advantage to using GoFileRoom for your client documentation is that you no longer must have multiple files floating around the office for one client. In GoFileRoom having all the departments broken out for one client makes it easy to share information across Tax, Assurance, Accounting, and any other specialty departments. If the staff does not file a document with the exact right indexes, you can do a search for all documents by client and still find what you are looking for!

Bookmarks

Your system allows you to create on screen bookmarks that can be applied to existing PDF documents. There are predefined entries for the individual and business tax return workpapers. You can edit these to fit your company's needs. The preset entries typically follow the order that you prepare the tax return. There have been instances that it makes sense to edit the order or content of the bookmarks. One such item is removing the "busines income" bookmark and breaking it out to Schedule C, Schedule E, and Schedule F. If you have purchased ScanFlow, these on-screen bookmarks will be printed with barcodes and serve as the divider pages for the scanned documents.

Library Drawer

The library drawer stores firm related documents that are available to the general staff. It works very similar to your county public library that offers information that is "borrowed" and can't be edited or changed but can be moved to the appropriate drawer and used as a template.

General information related to the firm can be found here. You can open documents, read them, or move it to another drawer to edit for another purpose. Only those with elevated permissions can add documents or edit the documents that live in this drawer.

Unlike the client drawer that groups by the client's name and number the library drawer groups by the service line. There is a general Firm area that holds HR documents like firm policies or Templates for generic items like letterhead or fax cover letters. Each department can also use the library so that they can share topics that are not client related but department related like research for corporate tax or research for assurance compilations.

Like all other lists in GoFileRoom you can edit these items. Please refer to the file section and document types at the beginning of this document for the do's and don'ts to consider.

MyFiles Drawer

MyFiles drawer is intended to offer your employees a place to store their personal documents that don't fit into the Firm related drawers. This area is a nice to have if you want to allow employees to store their personal tax returns outside of your tax prep program or if they have other employment documentation or volunteer items they want to keep. Allowing everyone in your office to save whatever documents they wish to your GoFileRoom may be a conversation to have with a legal advisor.

There is a bit of setup with security to make this available to the employees that can be learned through the Help and Support articles, your consultant, or the technical admin class.

There are a couple of items to note:

- the drawer is locked to the employee; however, the administrators of the system do have access to the individual area.
- The employees cannot change the document types.
- It is not custom or customizable to each user.
- If the employee leaves the firm, you must decide if you:
    - keep the files for some predetermined amount of time
    - share the files back to the employee
    - hold true that at termination of employment the documents are the sole property of the company

It is also vital, if you allow employees to store personal documents in GoFileRoom that part of the employment agreement discloses this information upfront to the employee before they start using the drawer.

Firm Admin

This drawer is meant to be for a smaller group of individuals in the firm and is usually at a manager or administrative level. The documents are more sensitive as it retains things like the company bank reconciliations, the disaster recovery documentation, and the IT departments documents. You can change the file sections and document types in this drawer to better suite your firm's needs, following the same "rules" listed at the beginning of the document. Some items that firms have added to this drawer are marketing, petty cash receipts, and client proposals.

Spending time considering what documents live in each drawer and which people need to access them will benefit you in the long run. It is grouped by File Section.

Partner

As the name implies this is a drawer that deals with firm level, private documents, and should be restricted to just those that need access. It carries items that may have Partner agreements, Firm financial statements, and Firm payroll reports.

HR

How many documents do you have that pertain to highly sensitive employee data and you are carrying it around on an encrypted hard drive or guarding it heavily on your work PC? With the HR drawer in GoFileRoom everything can be added to this file area. If a person doesn't have permission to the drawer, they will not know it exists and they cannot arbitrarily search to find anything that lives there.

Common documents that are stored here are typically employee related and are grouped by employee. Often their application, reviews, payroll information, benefit elections, or emergency contacts are kept here and are now easy to search and of course, secure! It is grouped by employee name which may be pulled from your practice management software.

CPE

This drawer is useful for tracking certificates. It does not track the amount of time spent in a category; however, many firms will add an Excel spreadsheet in that drawer to track time. This gives an advantage to your professional staff to keep all their certificates in one location and it is quickly accessible to management if they are looking for a certain topic to cover a client need. It is also searchable if they need to show a certificate for a certain purpose. It is grouped by employee name.

AP

An optional drawer that is available is the Accounts Payable drawer. Some clients like to keep a hard copy of the bills that have been paid with an attached copy of the check. These files can quickly fill up the file drawer in their desk or full filing cabinet in the backroom! So, taking advantage of this electronic storage gives you the freedom of getting to the information from any internet connection and it is searchable! It is grouped by the name of the vendor.

Recruiting

This can be used fully, or simply to keep records of resumes. If you have a big recruiting effort or have a dedicated recruiter this drawer can be very convenient for tracking who has applied and keeping interview notes. It is grouped by the name of the candidate which can be added using the Lookup List Permission.

RecordsFlow

RecordsFlow enables you to manage the permanent storage, purging, and archiving of documents by allowing you to set record retention policies using criteria such as document index formation, document input date, and creation date. Records retention is a critical component in complying with industry regulations for archiving and permanency, such as SEC rules, Sarbanes Oxley compliance, and internal company policies.

Creating the document retention policy structure that your business demands, yet providing the flexibility to set exclusions to policies, if necessary, takes document retention to a whole new level. You can assign specific individuals' privileges as Records Managers and approvers so that only certain people can archive and purge documents. The reports also ensure an accurate audit trail for all document management activities — a critical function in the event of an actual audit.

This section is covered in the GoFileRoom Technical Administration class and can be fully reviewed in articles in this Help and Support article group.

Conversion or Migration Considerations

Your documents currently live in another location, whether that is on a server, someone's hard drive, or another document management system, you are probably wondering how you will get your documents from the old to the new. As mentioned earlier in the document, you have the option to purchase a migration contract. Please consider that purchasing a contract does not mean that Thomson Reuters will be able to migrate your entire document library to GoFileRoom without you! You know your documents, your clients, and your filing system.

Rather, the part that Thomson Reuters plays is to complete the heavy lifting of getting the documents from one place to another, in the right place. The process takes six to eight weeks to complete once Thomson Reuters receives your hard drives, document mapping, and entity mapping.

Below are some common migration questions.

Why buy a migration contract?

It saves you and your staff time. It does take effort on your part, usually from an administrative staff member, to create and map the documents to the correct corresponding location between the old and the new, however, if you do not have the service the person would also need to download the documents from the old location and upload them to GoFileRoom. This can be accomplished using the control panel and creating profiles but there are likely more valuable things that staff could be doing. Some firms do choose to hire an intern to do this or have professional staff bring over documents as they are needed but, in most cases, firms report back they should have gone with the contract.

How much do I bring over?

You must learn to let go, a little. Most people only move document management systems every 10 to 15 years. That means your old system has a lot of data and, if you never purged, items that are obsolete. Consider that most lookback periods are around 3 years or less. Yes, there may be a handful of times that you need something older but is the system you are coming from available to serve as an archive location? If so, consider sticking to around a 3-year migration, keeping the legacy items in the legacy system.

How do I send my data?

You are responsible to get your existing data downloaded onto an encrypted hard drive that you purchase. The format required for the downloaded data depends on the system you are coming from. The document mapping and entity mapping will also be saved on the encrypted drive. The hard drive will be sent to a designated address at Thomson Reuters. You will have an encryption key that you will provide to Thomson Reuters when you send the drive. If you have Thomson Reuters Virtual Office, Thomson Reuters will download the data for you.

Is it really 8 weeks from the time they get the drive? Why does it take so long?

Yes. In rare cases it can go longer than eight weeks but, on average, eight weeks is fairly accurate. Here is a simple chart showing the expected breakdown of time. This can vary, depending on your firm, and the time is heavily related to how long it takes for you and the technical service team to agree on the final mapping as well as how much data you are bringing over.

Example Migration Schedule

Status / Date	Task Item	
Week 1	Data Transfer	GoFileRoom Technical Services Receives data
Week 1	Data Transfer	Firm sends initial client number mapping / entity mapping
Week 1-3 (depending on size of database)	Document Extraction	Technical Services will extract the information out of FileCabinet CS.
Week 3-5.	Document Mapping	Technical Services begins mapping documents to GoFileRoom indexes. Requests any additional information from firm needed to complete mapping
Week 5-6	Document Mapping	Firm reviews proposed mapping spreadsheet and offers changes or signs off on mapping.
Week 6-8	Document Upload	Technical Services begins uploading documents. 30,000 on weekdays and 40,000 on weekends.
Week 7-8	Document Reconciliation	Once all documents are uploaded. Technical Services will send Document Reconciliation report.
Week 7-8	Project Closed	Thomson Reuters closes project.

GoFileRoom Training

Onsite or Virtual Training

A variety of classes and training guides are available to assist your firm with the implementation of GoFileRoom. The number of classes required for your staff is determined by the specific audience and the number of users. Each web or onsite class that is specific to your firm should include a Business Process Owner to assist with office-specific implementation and procedural questions.

The comprehensive training course if taught onsite or over the web specific to your firm is called GoFileRoom Basics. All users who will use the program should take GoFileRoom Basics. This course will discuss how to add documents, search for them, and edit existing. Staff that are responsible for initial setup or staff that will manage the database should take the GoFileRoom Technical Administration class. Depending on the size of your firm, you may also want to consider attending additional classes like GoFileRoom Beyond the Basics for more high-level users.

For classes specific to your firm onsite or via the web:

- Confirm workstations meet system requirements
- Schedule and confirm training sessions
- Ensure that business process owner(s) are available for each web or onsite class
- Make sure IT support is available as needed – particularly in the beginning of each session

Thomson Reuters Tax & Accounting Professionals Learning Center

If your firm has an active subscription, they have access to the GoFileRoom course catalogue on the Thomson Reuters Tax & Accounting Professionals Learning Center:

- Confirm that each member of your staff has a Thomson Reuters Identification Number (TRID) if taking eLearning or live courses on the Thomson Reuters Learning Platform
- Make sure they can log-in at the My Account page.

Notes:

- The Firm ID and Firm Zip Code may be needed.
- DO NOT click "NEW USER REGISTRATION" from the training site. It will take approximately 24 hours for the Thomson Reuters Learning Platform to sync with a newly created or modified (e.g., changed password) TRID.
- CPE credit will be granted for all courses taken onsite or some courses over the web specific to your firm, depending on the contract. CPE credit will also be granted for courses taught as webinars via the Thomson Reuters Tax & Accounting Professionals Learning Center. CPE credit will not be granted for E-Learning courses via the Thomson Reuters Tax & Accounting Professionals Learning Center.

GoFileRoom FAQ's

This chapter provides answers to frequently asked questions about GoFileRoom

What does a restricted drawer mean?

Restricting a drawer allows you to protect highly sensitive data. Only the designated drawer owners have permission to the drawer, until they add other users. The owners maintain the integrity of the drawer. To learn more about restricted drawers please review this Help and Support article.

Are restricted files truly private?

The items that live in restricted drawers are truly private from anyone that does not have explicit permission to the drawer, even the administrator, so the partners can feel secure in keeping the firms documents under tight control.

How do I check if a file was compromised?

You can run a document tracking report, or request to 'show document history', on any document in the system to see what user has viewed, edited, moved, or reindexed a document. As you will learn in your classes, that is the case for all documents that live in GoFileRoom. It is grouped by File Section.

What is a required index?

You will notice when you are searching or adding a document, certain indexes are "required", they have an asterisk over the name, and must be answered to continue your action. These are set by default when your database is created. If you want to make changes to the required fields, you must ask support, or your consultant, as this is a system change that your administrator cannot edit. For more information on indexing in general, review this Help and Support article.

Additional Resources

For assistance using GoFileRoom refer to:

Product & Technical Support

Customer Help Center		Help and Support
GoFileRoom Support		(800) 968-0600
		Support Center